

Callum Harrod

Design Engineer & Lead Product Designer

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Design engineer and lead product designer with 10+ years' experience across front-end engineering and product design. I co-led the rebuild of Acquia's Site Studio in React, created the design system behind Drupal Canvas, and built the prototyping tool Acquia's design team uses to hand off designs as working React interfaces.

Design

Design systems, design tokens, component libraries, atomic design, UI design, UX design, prototyping, user research, user testing, Figma, Framer, AI design, AI prototyping

Development

React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, SCSS/Sass, Tailwind, Styled Components, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL, Shadow DOM, Webpack, Gulp, Jest, Cypress, Git, AngularJS, Webflow, WordPress, Drupal

Other

Accessibility (WCAG), design-to-dev handoff, rapid prototyping, stakeholder management, cross-functional collaboration, design critique, mentorship, junior designer training

Acquia / Lead Product Designer / Jan 2025 – Present

I joined Drupal Canvas (the largest Drupal initiative in years) as a front-end engineer, identified the absence of a design system, and took ownership, which is how I moved from engineering into design. I now lead design across Command Center (Acquia's flagship product unification initiative) and Acquia AI (automating work across Acquia's products).

- Built the prototyping and design tool used by the entire design team, so designs reach engineering as working React interfaces
- Built the Drupal Canvas design system from scratch on Radix UI; Canvas was adopted by 4,500+ websites in the 3.5 months after its 1.0 release
- Lead designer for Acquia AI, a greenfield agent orchestration tool, collaborating closely with product and engineering from ideation to production
- Owned end-to-end product design for Command Center, Acquia's largest current initiative, defining UX strategy, information architecture, interaction patterns, design strategy and more
- Worked with UX researchers on user testing sessions and iterated on designs based on their findings
- Mentored and trained junior designers on design system principles and Figma best practices

Acquia / Senior Software Engineer / May 2020 – Jan 2025

One of two engineers responsible for the entire Site Studio application, a low-code site builder. Rebuilt the full product in React and built a visual page builder from scratch, as the platform grew to support 1,000+ customers and \$45m attached revenue.

- One of two engineers that led the migration of 100,000+ lines of AngularJS to React, entirely redesigning the architecture in the process
- Built a reusable React component library using Styled Components, used across the whole application
- Developed a full end-to-end (E2E) testing suite with Cypress, achieving complete application coverage
- Designed new features in Figma and prototyped interactions before handoff
- Created onboarding materials including tutorial videos, documentation, webinars, and customer workshops

Cohesion & Acquia / Senior Frontend Designer / Sep 2018 – May 2020

Designer & Front-end Engineer responsible for creating all materials to educate and acquire new customers. Helped to land the £1m ARR deal that led to us being acquired by Acquia.

- Co-led the pitch that landed Bayer Pharmaceuticals as a client at £1m ARR over a single weekend: the Design Director and I designed and built a full branded prototype that stopped the room on Monday morning
- Bayer subsequently migrated over 1,000 websites onto Site Studio, validating the product's enterprise scalability
- The deal was a direct catalyst for Acquia's acquisition of Cohesion. Acquia recognised Site Studio as a unique asset in the Drupal ecosystem
- Built a complete tutorial video library, webinar programme, mock designs, and documentation from scratch to enable customer self-service onboarding
- Visited companies internationally alongside the marketing director to demonstrate the product live, building enterprise pipeline from zero

WeMakeWebsites / Frontend Designer / May 2018 – Sep 2018

Shopify-focused agency. Led design of the Union Coffee website (Employee of the Month). Worked with Skinnydip and Pepsi.

Pragmatic / Designer & Developer / Jun 2016 – May 2018

Full-stack development, CRO, and UI/UX design for high-profile clients including Sage and Bacardi. Delivered sites for major brands and managed projects end-to-end.

UnitedUs / Web Developer / Apr 2015 – Jun 2016

First professional role. Front-end and back-end web development for multiple clients across a range of industries.